ChatGPT

AICTE Affiliating University/Board NOC Verification — APH 2024–27

Executive summary

The **Affiliating University/Board No Objection Certificate is AICTE Format-2**, printed on **APH pages 202–204**. It is not a generic NOC used for every application. AICTE requires it for specific approval categories, including Change of Site/Location, conversion of institution type/level, starting a new Programme/Level, merger, closure, and certain name changes. Annexure-2 specifies when it must be produced during scrutiny. [1]

The most important finding for your prototype is that **AICTE does not publish a separate field-by-field "officer NOC verification SOP."** The public APH instead places the NOC inside the broader Scrutiny/Re-Scrutiny process: the **Scrutiny Committee is explicitly responsible for verifying the authenticity of Annexure-1/2 documents**, deficiencies are communicated through the portal, and Re-Scrutiny examines only the deficiencies identified earlier. [2]

This means your product should **assist the Scrutiny process, not pretend to make AICTE's final decision**. The strongest prototype is:

> **NOC upload → OCR extraction → determine approval scenario → apply scenario-specific APH rules → compare against application + Trust resolution → highlight contradictions/ missing evidence → human review for authenticity → generate an explainable verification report.**

There are three particularly important rules to build correctly:

1. **Do not require an exact template match.** AICTE itself says that formats issued by institutions are acceptable when they reflect the content of the prescribed Format; irrelevant portions may be struck off. [3]
2. **Do not invent an NOC expiry or tenure rule.** Format-2 contains meeting/application dates but does not prescribe a universal "NOC valid for X months" period. Date checks should therefore test consistency, impossible/future dates and applicable submission deadlines rather than an invented expiry. [4]
3. **Signature/seal detection is not authentication.** Format-2 ends with the designation **Registrar/ Director** of the affiliating University/Board; image processing can detect whether a signature/stamp-like region exists, but genuine authority or authenticity requires authoritative/manual verification. [5]

Best hackathon demonstration: start with **Change of Site/Location**. It provides obvious, explainable comparisons—Institution Name, Trust, old address, new address, University/Board, application reference

and purpose—and AICTE's processing table routes Change of Site/Location through Scrutiny/Re-Scrutiny and EVC. [6]

Regulatory map and required NOC content

Where exactly the NOC appears in APH

The page numbers below are the **printed APH page numbers**, not the PDF viewer index.

APH reference	Printed page	How Format-2 NOC is used
Chapter II, Clause 2.6, Note 3	**17**	For relevant Increase-in-Intake/Additional-Course processing, the institution is responsible for obtaining NOC from the affiliating University and State Government, if applicable, before the academic session. [7]
Chapter II, Clause 2.17	**25**	Change of Site/Location applications are submitted through the AICTE portal with applicable Annexure-2 documents. [8]
Chapter II, Clause 2.18	**25–26**	Change/Merger of courses, reduction in intake and closure of Programme/Course are linked to Annexure-2 documentation. [9]
Chapter II, Clause 2.19	**26**	Change of Institution Name, affiliating University/Board or Type uses Annexure-2 documents. The base APH also contains a University/Board views procedure here; academic-year addenda must be checked before implementing it as a current rule. [10]
Chapter II, Clause 2.21	**27**	Closure of Institution requires the additional documents prescribed by Annexure-2. [9]
Annexure-2, Clause 2.3	**81**	Format-2 required at Scrutiny for **Change of Site/Location, Women↔Co-ed conversion, Diploma↔Degree conversion and starting new Programme/Level**. [11]
Annexure-2, Clause 2.4	**82**	Format-2 required for **Merger of Institutions**. [11]
Annexure-2, Clause 2.7	**82–83**	Closure NOC must clearly mention provisions/alternative arrangements for existing students. [12]
Annexure-2, Clause 2.8	**83**	Format-2 required for **Change of Type of Institution**, including conversion into a University. [12]
Annexure-2, Clause 2.9	**83**	For **Closure of Programme/Course**, the NOC must mention alternative arrangements for existing students. [12]
Annexure-2, Clause 2.10	**83**	For **Change in Institution Name**, either Format-2 **or an officially sealed receipt from the authorized University/Board signatory proving submission** is accepted. [12]

APH reference	Printed page	How Format-2 NOC is used
Annexure-2, Clause 2.11	**83–84**	The same NOC-or-official-receipt alternative applies to **Change in affiliating University/Board name**. [12]
FORMAT-2	**202–204**	Prescribed content of the **No Objection Certificate from the Affiliating University/Board**. [4]

There is an important distinction for your rule engine: **"Format-2 contains a scenario" does not necessarily mean "a Format-2 NOC must be produced at Scrutiny for every occurrence of that scenario."** The actual requirement should come from the applicable Chapter II clause plus Annexure-2 and the academic-year corrigendum/addendum. AICTE's official FAQ, for example, says an NOC is required for an additional course while the base APH's Clause 2.6 places responsibility for obtaining that NOC before the academic session. [13]

Fields that should be extracted

Format-2 spans three printed pages and supports several different approval purposes. Your schema should therefore have **core fields** plus **scenario-specific fields**, rather than assuming every document contains every possible field. [4]

Field	Requirement for prototype	What to verify
Trust/Society/Company name	Core	Match applicant/master application
Executive meeting date	Core where Format-2 wording follows APH	Valid date; compare with Format-3 resolution
Meeting place	Core where present	Extract; absence in an equivalent format should usually trigger review rather than automatic rejection
Resolution item number	Core where prescribed	Compare with Trust/Society resolution if available
Institution name	Core	Exact/normalized match with application
Institution address	Core	Match relevant old/current/new address
Application reference number	Core where given	Match application record
Application date	Core where given	Parse and check logical consistency
Affiliating University/ Board	Core	Match declared affiliating authority
NOC purpose	**Critical**	Must correspond to the application category

Field	Requirement for prototype	What to verify
Old/new institution address	Change of Site	Cross-check both addresses
Old/new institution name	Name change	Cross-check application
Programme/Course	Programme/course changes	Match programme/course requested
Proposed intake	Where applicable	Compare to application
Institutions being merged	Merger	Names, addresses and campus/city relationship
Current/trailing students	Closure	Extract student counts
Student rearrangement	Closure	**Required evidence for closure scenarios**
Staff rearrangement/ liabilities	Closure-related	Flag omissions/inconsistencies
Signer designation	Core	Expected Format-2 endpoint is Registrar/ Director
University/Board identity at signature block	Core	Match issuer in body
Signature visual presence	Supporting signal	Detect only; do not claim authenticity
Seal/stamp visual presence	Supporting signal	Detect if present; not universally required by Format-2 itself

The actual template names the **Registrar/Director** at the end and permits other institutional formats that reproduce the relevant content. It also tells users to strike off inapplicable items. Therefore, an OCR engine that insists on the exact sequence of headings or three exact pages would incorrectly reject legitimate variants. [14]

Acceptable variants

Your rules should explicitly handle three cases.

Content-equivalent NOC: AICTE states that formats supplied by institutions which reflect the content of the prescribed format are acceptable. Therefore, typography, letterhead, page count and sentence wording are weak validation signals; substantive fields are stronger signals. [3]

Struck-out/omitted irrelevant clauses: the template says to strike off whichever is not applicable. A Change-of-Site NOC should therefore not fail because it does not preserve the text for closure, merger and every other possible category. [14]

Receipt instead of NOC: this alternative is specifically stated for Annexure-2 Clauses **2.10 and 2.11**—Change of Institution Name and Change of affiliating University/Board name. The receipt must have the official seal from an authorized signatory and prove submission. Do **not** generalize that alternative to Change of Site or Closure unless the applicable rules separately allow it. [12]

Published verification workflow

What AICTE publicly specifies

AICTE does **not** publish a document saying, for example, "Officer opens NOC, first checks line 3, then checks the seal database." The strongest defensible description is therefore the **published approval workflow into which the NOC enters**. Annexure-16 states that the Scrutiny Committee verifies authenticity of documents submitted under Annexure-1/2; the APH then defines deficiency, Re-Scrutiny, EVC, hearing and appeal mechanisms. [15]

Stage	Published actor	What happens to the NOC / application	Timing or escalation
Application submission	Institution / applicant	Application and applicable Annexure-2 documents are submitted through the AICTE process.	Some categories follow the Public Notice period; Change of Site, Closure and several others are processed year-round. [16]
Scheduling	AICTE Regulation Bureau	Date/time of Scrutiny/Re-Scrutiny is communicated to the institution and experts.	According to the AICTE processing schedule. [17]
Presentation of evidence	Two authorized representatives of applicant	Applicant representatives present the application and supporting documents.	They must follow the scheduled scrutiny. [17]
Scrutiny	Scrutiny Committee	Committee checks applicable Annexure-2 documentation. Annexure-16 explicitly assigns it responsibility to **verify authenticity** of submitted documents.	Primary document-verification stage. [18]
Deficiency communication	AICTE / Regulation process	Deficiencies identified by Scrutiny are communicated through the AICTE portal.	Applicant is expected to rectify/provide compliance. [17]
Re-Scrutiny	Re-Scrutiny Committee	Checks **only the deficiencies identified by the original Scrutiny Committee**.	If documents become compliant, the application moves forward as applicable. [17]

Stage	Published actor	What happens to the NOC / application	Timing or escalation
EVC, when applicable	Expert Visit Committee	EVC primarily verifies infrastructure, facilities and faculty against norms. It is not described as the main NOC-authentication authority.	Only categories marked for EVC in Table 2.3 go through this stage. [19]
Hearing/ compliance	Standing Hearing Committee	Institution may submit compliance for shortcomings arising from Scrutiny/Re-Scrutiny/EVC where the processing route makes this applicable.	Recommendation goes to Executive Committee. [16]
Decision	Executive Committee / Council process	Decision is uploaded to the portal with a speaking order as prescribed by the applicable process.	Applicant can appeal when eligible. [16]
Appeal	Standing Appellate Committee, then Council	Supporting evidence for deficiencies is examined; recommendation goes to Council.	Chapter II provides **one appeal within 7 days of upload of the Executive Committee decision**. [16]

Annexure-16 says that for Chapter II Scrutiny/Re-Scrutiny the committee composition includes **two Professors/Associate Professors from IIT/IIM/NIT/Government/Government-aided institutions**. It also permits a State Government/UT/affiliating University/Board representative at the prescribed level to be co-opted depending on requirement. [20]

Which applications continue to EVC?

This matters because your product should not display the same workflow for every NOC.

Table 2.3 shows **Scrutiny + EVC** for categories such as **Change of Site/Location, starting a new Programme/Level, merger and Diploma↔Degree conversion**. By contrast, Change of Institution/ Affiliating University name, Closure of Institution, Women↔Co-ed conversion and Closure of Programme/ Course are shown with Scrutiny but no standard EVC step in that table. [21]

For a Change-of-Site demo, the route is therefore approximately:



This is a **workflow synthesis of the published APH**, not an assertion that AICTE exposes a dedicated NOC microservice or an internal officer screen with these exact boxes. The published basis is Chapter I Clause 1.8, Chapter II Clauses 2.23–2.24, Table 2.3 and Annexure-16. [22]

Timing caveat you should know

The base APH differentiates **Public-Notice categories** from **year-round categories**. Change of Site/Location, Closure of Institution, Women↔Co-ed conversion and Closure of Programme/Course are listed as year-round; applications received after the relevant cut-off may be processed for a succeeding academic year where the APH so provides. [16]

The base APH's Clause 2.19 also contains a **15-day University/Board views provision** for certain name/type changes. However, AICTE publishes academic-year addenda/corrigenda—including an official **2026–27 addendum**—so this is exactly the kind of rule that should be **versioned rather than hard-coded permanently**. [23]

For the hackathon, show the judge:

```
Rule source: APH 2024–27 → Annexure-2 → Clause 2.3 → printed p.81 → AY rule-pack: 2026–27
```

That is much stronger than simply displaying “AI says document invalid.”

Automation, OCR mapping and decision rules

What the prototype can safely automate

The correct architecture is **document intelligence + deterministic regulatory rules + human review**, rather than asking an LLM to decide whether an institution deserves approval.

Check	Automate?	Recommended behaviour
Document classification	**Yes**	Detect University/Board NOC or equivalent-content document
Institution name	**Yes**	OCR + normalized comparison against application
Trust/Society/Company name	**Yes**	Cross-check application and Format-3
University/Board	**Yes**	Compare issuer with declared affiliating body
Application reference	**Yes**	Exact/normalized reference comparison
Purpose of NOC	**Yes — critical**	Must correspond to approval category
Old/new location	**Yes**	Address-normalized comparison
Programme/Course	**Yes**	Compare with requested programme/ course
Intake	**Yes**	Numeric comparison
Meeting date	**Yes**	Parse and detect impossible/future dates
Resolution item number	**Yes**	Compare against Format-3 if provided
Closure student details	**Yes**	Extract current/trailing student counts
Student rearrangement present	**Yes**	Required-content check for relevant closure application
Signature region	**Partly**	Detect visual presence; never state “signature authentic”
Seal/stamp region	**Partly**	Risk indicator only unless authoritative verification exists
PDF page count	**Yes**	Useful signal, but not a template-validity rule
PDF metadata	**Yes**	Extract creation/modification information and hashes as audit/risk evidence

Check	Automate?	Recommended behaviour
Genuine issuer authority	**No, without authoritative source/ API**	Human or authoritative verification
Genuine signature	**No**	Human/cryptographic/issuer verification
Genuine physical seal	**No**	Human/issuer verification
Adequacy of student rearrangement plan	**Assist only**	Officer judgment
Ambiguous legal interpretation	**No**	Escalate to reviewer
Final AICTE approval/ rejection	**No**	Official competent authority only

The reason to keep the last group manual is that AICTE assigns **authenticity verification to the Scrutiny Committee**, while the APH allows equivalent-content formats. A prototype can detect contradictions and fraud indicators, but it has no public authoritative source that lets it conclusively establish that an image of a Registrar's signature is genuine. [24]

Sample OCR field mapping

A practical canonical object for a Change-of-Site NOC could look like this:

```
{
  "document_type": "AFFILIATING_UNIVERSITY_NOC",
  "format_reference": "APH_FORMAT_2",

  "issuer": {
    "university_or_board": "Example State Technical University",
    "signer_designation": "Registrar"
  },

  "applicant": {
    "trust_name": "Example Education Trust",
    "institution_name": "Example Institute of Technology",
    "institution_address": "Old Campus Address"
  },

  "resolution": {
    "meeting_date": "2026-01-12",
    "meeting_place": "Bengaluru",
    "item_number": "EC/12/2026"
  },
```

```
  "application": {
    "reference_number": "1-1234567890",
    "reference_date": "2026-01-15",
    "purpose": "CHANGE_OF_SITE"
  },

  "change_of_site": {
    "old_address": "Old Campus Address",
    "new_address": "Proposed New Campus Address"
  },

  "document_signals": {
    "signature_region_detected": true,
    "seal_region_detected": true,
    "ocr_confidence": 0.94
  }
}
```

For every extracted field, store more than its value:

```
value
source_page
bounding_box
OCR confidence
normalized_value
cross-check source
rule result
reviewer override
```

Tesseract can generate structured OCR outputs such as **TSV/hOCR**, which makes it possible to retain text position and confidence information rather than storing only a plain-text dump. Tesseract's own guidance also notes that image quality and resolution matter, with roughly 300 DPI being a useful target for OCR input. [25]

Date and “tenure” checks

For this NOC, **do not build a rule such as** `issue_date + 6 months > today` **unless another applicable AICTE or affiliating-university rule explicitly establishes it**. Format-2 itself does not give a universal validity/expiry duration. [4]

Useful date checks are instead:

- meeting date parses as a real date;
- application date parses correctly;
- no clearly impossible/future date relative to the transaction;
- dates and reference numbers agree with supporting documents;

- the application falls into the applicable Public Notice/year-round processing regime;
- any academic-year-specific requirement comes from the **versioned rule pack**, not from hard-coded assumptions. [26]

Recommended decision model

Do not call the system output **"AICTE Approved / Rejected."**

Use:

PRE-CHECK PASSED → no deterministic inconsistency found.

REVIEW REQUIRED → evidence is uncertain or cannot be authenticated automatically.

DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE → a specific APH-linked requirement is missing or contradictory.

This preserves human authority and gives every finding an explanation.

Example	System result	Reason
Change-of-Site NOC says Old Address A → New Address B; application says the same; Trust/University/reference all match	**PRE-CHECK PASSED**	No deterministic inconsistency found against selected rule set
NOC says New Address **Mysuru**, application says **Mandya**	**DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE**	Change-of-Site field contradicts application; Format-2 expressly represents old/new locations. [27]
Application purpose is Change of Site but uploaded NOC grants no objection only for Starting New Course	**DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE**	NOC purpose does not support requested approval scenario. [27]
Closure NOC has no provisions for existing students	**DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE**	Annexure-2 specifically requires provisions/alternative arrangements for existing students for closure. [12]
University's NOC uses different wording/layout but contains all corresponding substantive information	**PRE-CHECK PASSED / REVIEW if ambiguous**	Exact template appearance is not mandatory; content-equivalent formats are accepted. [28]
Signature appears visually but OCR cannot determine designation	**REVIEW REQUIRED**	Presence can be detected; signer's authority/authenticity cannot safely be inferred

Example	System result	Reason
Change-of-Institution-Name application has no full NOC but has an officially sealed receipt proving submission	**PRE-CHECK PASSED for document requirement**	Annexure-2 Clause 2.10 expressly permits this alternative. [12]
Same receipt is uploaded for Change of Site	**DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE / REVIEW**	The receipt alternative in Clauses 2.10/2.11 should not automatically be generalized to Clause 2.3. [29]
NOC is “eight months old” but otherwise matches	**Do not fail on age alone**	No universal Format-2 expiry period is stated in the cited APH provisions. [4]

The report shown to the reviewer should therefore say something like:

> **Address mismatch detected**
> Application: *24 Example Road, Bengaluru*
> University NOC: *42 Example Road, Bengaluru*
> Rule source: *APH 2024–27, Format-2, p.202; Annexure-2 §2.3, p.81*
> Action: **Verify source document / request corrected evidence**

That is explainable and auditable.

Demo evidence and synthetic test cases

Evidence bundle to prepare

For a convincing hackathon demo, prepare a **small evidence package**, not fifty random PDFs.

For the Change-of-Site scenario I would use:

Application record → Format-2 NOC → Format-3 Trust Resolution → synthetic institution master record → rule pack → OCR evidence → verification result.

Annexure-2 explicitly pairs the Format-2 NOC with a **Format-3 Trust/Society/Company resolution** for Change of Site and several other categories, making it a natural cross-document comparison. [11]

Store this evidence with the demo:

Evidence	Why it matters
Synthetic AICTE-style application JSON	Ground truth for comparisons
Synthetic Format-2 NOC PDF	OCR/document-under-test
Synthetic Format-3 resolution	Cross-document validation

Evidence	Why it matters
Screenshot/excerpt of APH rule	Shows the judge where your rule came from
OCR JSON with page/bounding boxes/confidence	Demonstrates extraction is auditable
Rule execution trace	Shows why a finding was produced
Original file SHA-256	Demonstrates document integrity tracking
Reviewer action log	Demonstrates human-in-the-loop workflow

Synthetic test cases

You asked for at least four; I recommend **six** because together they demonstrate almost all the important edge cases.

Test	Synthetic document setup	Expected outcome	What it demonstrates
Valid Change of Site	NOC, application and Format-3 all show Institution A moving from Address X to Address Y; University and Trust match	**PRE-CHECK PASSED**	Basic OCR + cross-document verification
Address mismatch	NOC says new address Y; application says address Z	**DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE**	Semantic field comparison
Wrong NOC purpose	Application = Change of Site; NOC = Starting New Course	**DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE**	Scenario-specific rule selection
Equivalent-format University letter	Different layout and wording but contains same institution, Trust, purpose, addresses and authorized signatory	**PRE-CHECK PASSED / REVIEW**	Avoids false failure from rigid template matching; APH accepts content-equivalent formats. [28]
Closure missing student plan	Closure NOC exists but does not mention arrangements for existing students	**DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE**	Annexure-2 closure-specific requirement. [12]
Low-quality scan	All information exists but OCR confidence on reference/ signature is low	**REVIEW REQUIRED**, not automatic failure	Human-in-the-loop behaviour

A particularly effective live demo is to run **Test 2**, show the mismatch highlighted on the actual NOC and application, then upload the corrected synthetic document and rerun the rules so that the status changes from **DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE → PRE-CHECK PASSED**.

That visually proves what your product contributes.

Example test data

For example:

```
APPLICATION
Institution: Horizon Institute of Technology
Trust: Horizon Education Trust
Affiliating University: Karnataka Example Technological University
Purpose: Change of Site / Location
Old Address: 18 Knowledge Road, Bengaluru
New Address: 72 Innovation Avenue, Bengaluru

BAD NOC
Old Address: 18 Knowledge Road, Bengaluru
New Address: 27 Innovation Avenue, Bengaluru
```

Expected rule trace:

```
RULE NOC-SITE-004

Source:
APH 2024–27
Annexure-2 §2.3, printed p.81
Format-2, printed p.202

Check:
application.new_address == noc.new_address

Expected:
72 Innovation Avenue, Bengaluru

Observed:
27 Innovation Avenue, Bengaluru

Result:
DEFICIENCY CANDIDATE

Reviewer action:
Confirm correct site address / request revised evidence.
```

All names and addresses in your demo should be clearly marked **synthetic/test data** so the prototype does not look as though it is issuing a genuine University certificate.

Security, privacy and portal integration

Security model

This prototype will handle potentially sensitive institutional documents, names, addresses, signatures and applicant information. For a government-facing architecture, the relevant baseline is not merely “we use login/password”; CERT-In publishes security practices specifically for Government entities, while GIGW 3.0 includes cybersecurity, privacy, access-control and production security-audit requirements. [30]

For the MVP, implement:

Control	MVP implementation
Role-based access	Institution uploader / reviewer / admin roles
Least privilege	Reviewer sees only assigned cases
Encryption in transit	HTTPS/TLS
Encryption at rest	Encrypted file/object storage for real deployments
Immutable audit log	Upload, OCR, rule execution, reviewer override, download
File hashing	SHA-256 hash when document is received
Malware/file validation	PDF/image type and size validation; scan before processing
Document isolation	Unique case storage and authorization checks
Log hygiene	Never place full document text, signatures or personal information in ordinary application logs
Data minimization	Store only what the workflow actually needs
Deletion/retention policy	Configurable according to deployment authority's policy
Human override history	Record who overrode a finding, why, and when

GIGW's conformity matrix says production government web applications should undergo security audit and obtain audit clearance from NIC, STQC or a CERT-In-empanelled vendor, and should have defined security/privacy/contingency policies. That is a **production requirement to plan for**, not something your hackathon prototype needs to falsely claim it already has. [31]

GIGW also incorporates accessibility requirements based on WCAG and explicitly discusses OCR for scanned PDF content, so an eventual government-facing interface should provide accessible text rather than relying only on scanned-document images and colour-coded warnings. [32]

Privacy caveat for October 2026

India's **Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023** and **DPDP Rules, 2025** are relevant to product design, but the implementation timeline is staged. The November 2025 commencement notification and Rules specify that multiple substantive provisions commence later rather than all simultaneously. Therefore, as of **25 October 2026**, you should design for privacy-by-default and upcoming obligations without inaccurately saying every substantive DPDP provision is already in force today. [33]

For the hackathon, the easiest privacy-safe decision is:

> **Use synthetic NOCs and synthetic institution/application records. Do not upload real signatures, phone numbers or institutional confidential documents unless you have authority to use them.**

Integration constraint with AICTE

Under your stated assumption that there is **no authorized AICTE internal API**, the MVP should **not attempt to write directly into the AICTE portal, bypass authentication, or scrape authenticated officer pages**.

Use a separate pre-check architecture:

```
Synthetic / user-provided application data
                ↓
        Document upload
                ↓
        OCR + field extraction
                ↓
       Versioned APH rule engine
                ↓
       Cross-document matching
                ↓
        Human review queue
                ↓
 PDF/JSON verification report
```

Treat the official AICTE portal as the **system of record** and your prototype as an **assistive verification layer**. Any later production integration should use an interface formally provided/authorized by AICTE, with authentication, authorization, logging and data-sharing requirements agreed by the authority. This is an architectural recommendation based on the absence of a specified API in the scope and government security expectations; it is not a claim that AICTE has no internal APIs. [34]

Also store the **rule version** used on every verification:

```
Document check ID: CHECK-2026-00041
APH base: 2024–27
Academic year: 2026–27
Addendum version: 2026–27
Rule: Annexure-2 §2.3
Format: Format-2
Executed: 25-Oct-2026 17:14 IST
```

That versioning is particularly important because AICTE has issued an official **Corrigendum/Addendum for Approval Process 2026–27** on top of the multi-year APH. [35]

MVP priorities and references

What to build first

For the hackathon, I would prioritize development in this order:

P0 — Build this first

Implement **one application category: Change of Site/Location**. Create a structured application record, upload Format-2 NOC and Format-3 resolution, OCR the core fields, compare old/new addresses, institution name, Trust, University/Board, application reference and purpose, then produce an APH-linked finding. Change of Site is particularly useful because Annexure-2 §2.3 clearly specifies Format-2 and Format-3 and Table 2.3 gives it a Scrutiny + EVC route. [6]

P1 — Make the output explainable

Every rule result should contain:

```
WHAT was checked
WHAT was extracted
WHAT it was compared against
WHICH APH rule requires it
WHERE in the document the evidence was found
WHY it passed / needs review / is a deficiency candidate
```

This is more valuable than building a generic “92% compliant” score with no regulatory explanation.

P1 — Add human review

Create a reviewer screen showing the original NOC beside extracted fields. Clicking an extracted field should highlight its source region. Low-confidence OCR, unclear signature/issuer and ambiguous equivalent formats go to the reviewer rather than becoming automatic failures. Tesseract's structured OCR outputs make field-level location/confidence handling technically feasible. [25]

P1 — Implement a versioned rule catalogue

For example:

```
rule_id: NOC_CHANGE_SITE_NEW_ADDRESS
aph_version: "2024-27"
academic_year: "2026-27"
source:
  annexure: 2
  clause: "2.3"
  printed_page: 81
  format: 2

applies_when:
  application_type: CHANGE_OF_SITE

check:
  left: application.new_address
  operator: address_match
  right: noc.new_address

on_mismatch:
  status: DEFICIENCY_CANDIDATE
  message: "Proposed site in NOC does not match application."
```

P2 — Add a second scenario

Make **Closure of Programme/Institution** your second rule pack because it demonstrates a rule that is more than a simple name/address match: the APH explicitly requires alternative arrangements for existing students. [12]

P2 — Add document forensics as risk indicators

Add SHA-256, duplicate-document detection, file metadata, page count, signature/stamp-region detection and suspicious-edit indicators. Keep them visibly labelled **risk indicators**, not proof of forgery.

P3 — Integrate only when authorized

Institution/university registries, digital-signature verification, issuer verification and AICTE portal synchronization should come later when authoritative data sources or APIs are formally available.

The most important thing your team should be able to explain

When a judge asks:

> **“How do you know your system's decision is correct?”**

Your answer should be:

> “The system does not independently grant or reject AICTE approval. It extracts evidence from the submitted document, executes versioned rules derived from the applicable APH clause, shows the exact source and mismatch to the reviewer, and escalates authenticity or ambiguous cases to human verification. Final regulatory authority stays with the prescribed AICTE process.”

That positioning is consistent with the APH's assignment of document authenticity verification to the Scrutiny Committee and avoids overstating what OCR/AI can establish. [18]

Slide-ready version

For one PPT slide, I would reduce the whole research to:

AICTE NOC Verification — Research Findings

Official process	Prototype automation
Format-2 NOC — APH pp. **202–204**	OCR institution, Trust, University, dates, purpose, address/course
Requirement depends on **Annexure-2 scenario**	Select scenario-specific APH rule
Scrutiny Committee verifies document authenticity	Cross-check NOC ↔ application ↔ Format-3
Deficiencies → Re-Scrutiny	Explain exact mismatch + APH source
EVC only where Table 2.3 requires it	Route case according to application type
Equivalent-content NOC formats are accepted	Content-based, not rigid template matching
Closure requires student arrangements	Automated required-content check
Authenticity remains human/authority decision	Low-confidence/signature cases → reviewer

Demo:
`Upload NOC → Extract → Cross-check → APH Rule → Deficiency/Review/Pass → Evidence`

Key rule: AI assists verification; it does not replace AICTE's Scrutiny Committee. [36]

Direct references

AICTE — Approval Process Handbook 2024–27
Primary source for Chapter II, Annexure-2, Annexure-16 and Formats 1–3. [37]
https://cdnbbsr.s3waas.gov.in/s35938b4d054136e5d59ada6ec9c295d7a/uploads/2025/03/2025031399.pdf

AICTE — Corrigendum/Addendum for Approval Process 2026–27
Use this as the academic-year overlay instead of assuming the base APH is unchanged. [35]
https://aicte.gov.in/downloads/aph/Final%20Addendum%202026-27.pdf

AICTE — 2026–27 Addendum page [38]
https://www.aicte.gov.in/node/3309

AICTE — Approval Process FAQs
Useful corroboration for NOC requirements such as additional courses. [39]
https://www.aicte.gov.in/sites/default/files/FAQ%20Updated.pdf

Ministry of Education / PIB — Launch of APH 2024–27
The Ministry described the new APH as simplifying procedures and reducing certain NOC/land-document compliances. [40]
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1983013

CERT-In — Guidelines on Information Security Practices for Government Entities [41]
https://www.cert-in.org.in/PDF/guidelinesgovtentities.pdf

NIC/MeitY — Guidelines for Indian Government Websites and Apps, GIGW 3.0 [34]
https://guidelines.india.gov.in/guidelines/

GIGW — Security Guidelines [42]
https://guidelines.india.gov.in/security-guidelines-and-attributes/

GIGW — Accessibility Guidelines [32]
https://guidelines.india.gov.in/accessibility-guidelines-and-attributes/

MeitY — Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 [43]
https://www.meity.gov.in/static/uploads/2024/06/2bf1f0e9f04e6fb4f8fef35e82c42aa5.pdf

MeitY — Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025
Important to read with the staged commencement dates. [44]
https://www.meity.gov.in/static/uploads/2025/11/53450e6e5dc0bfa85ebd78686cadad39.pdf

Tesseract OCR — Improving OCR Quality
Useful for document preprocessing; official documentation recommends adequate scan quality and notes approximately 300 DPI as a useful target. [45]
https://tesseract-ocr.github.io/tessdoc/ImproveQuality.html

Tesseract OCR — Documentation
Supports structured OCR output including TSV/hOCR that can retain position/confidence information for explainable extraction. [46]
https://tesseract-ocr.github.io/tessdoc/

Bottom-line architecture for the MVP: one Change-of-Site application, one Format-2 NOC, one Format-3 resolution, roughly 8–12 deterministic checks, field-level OCR evidence, three outcomes—Pre-check Passed / Review Required / Deficiency Candidate—and an APH citation attached to every regulatory finding. That is narrow enough to build reliably in a hackathon and deep enough to demonstrate genuine research rather than a generic document-upload dashboard. [47]

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[1] [2] [3] [4] [5] [6] [7] [8] [9] [10] [11] [12] [14] [15] [16] [17] [18] [19] [20] [21] [22] [23] [24] [26] [27] [28] [29] [36] [37] [47]
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[13] [39] Approval Process 2024-25
https://www.aicte.gov.in/sites/default/files/FAQ%20Updated.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com

[25] [45] Improving the quality of the output - Tesseract documentation
https://tesseract-ocr.github.io/tessdoc/ImproveQuality.html?utm_source=chatgpt.com

[30] [41] Guidelines on Information Security Practices for ...
https://www.cert-in.org.in/PDF/guidelinesgovtentities.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com

[31] Annexure II : Matrix to check conformity
https://guidelines.india.gov.in/annexure-ii-matrix-to-check-conformity/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

[32] 2. Accessibility: Guidelines and Attributes
https://guidelines.india.gov.in/accessibility-guidelines-and-attributes/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

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[40] AICTE releases Approval Process Handbook for Academic ...
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1983013&utm_source=chatgpt.com

[42] 3. Security: Guidelines and Attributes
https://guidelines.india.gov.in/security-guidelines-and-attributes/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

[44] सी.जी.-डी.एल.-अ.-14112025-267650 CG-DL-E- ...
https://www.meity.gov.in/static/uploads/2025/11/53450e6e5dc0bfa85ebd78686cadad39.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com

[46] tessdoc - Tesseract documentation - GitHub Pages
https://tesseract-ocr.github.io/tessdoc/tess3/FAQ-Old.html?utm_source=chatgpt.com